

CBD Plant & Labour — Operations Portal Guidebook

CBD Plant & Labour
May 2026

Table of Contents

CBD Plant & Labour — Operations Portal Guide 1

1. Overview 1

2. Roles & Access2

3. Onboarding Flow2

4. Allocations (Scheduling).....3

5. Timesheets.....4

6. Payroll.....5

7. Dashboard6

8. Common Tasks (Cheat Sheet).....6

9. Database Tables (for reference)6

10. Support / Common Issues7

CBD Plant & Labour — Operations Portal Guide

A full guide for how the system works, who does what, and how everything links together.

1. Overview

The portal is the central system for running labour-hire operations. It replaces the old paper / spreadsheet flow with a single live database for:

- **Workers** — your full-time, casual, and subcontractor pool
- **Clients & Jobs** — who you supply labour to, and which projects they have running
- **Allocations** — which worker is sent to which job on which day
- **Timesheets** — actual hours worked, who pays what, what the client gets charged
- **Payroll** — wage calculation + Xero export
- **Licences / Tickets** — every worker’s certifications and expiry dates

- **App Views** — what each worker sees on their phone

The portal has **two faces**: - **Admin Portal** — for office staff (Matt, ops team) - **Worker Portal** — what each worker sees once invited

You toggle between them with the  **Worker View** button in the top bar of the admin portal — useful for previewing exactly what workers see before sending anything out.

2. Roles & Access

Role	Access
Admin (role = admin)	Full portal access — workers, allocations, timesheets, payroll, clients, all settings
Manager (access_level = manager)	Admin-level access for senior office staff
Worker (role = worker)	Mobile portal only — sees their own allocations, submits timesheets, clocks in/out, views their tickets

Each user logs in with their email — the role is set on their worker record.

3. Onboarding Flow

3.1 Adding a Client

Clients & Rates → + **Add Client**

Fill in: - **Name** (required) - **Contact details** — person, phone, email - **Charge rates** — Regular, OT, Night, Weekend (\$/hr you bill the client) - **Allowance charges** — Travel, Meal (what you bill on top per shift)

These rates feed the payroll calculator: when a timesheet is approved, the system uses the client's rates to compute charge_amount (what to invoice).

3.2 Adding Jobs Under a Client

Clients & Rates → click **"Jobs"** button on a client row

Each client can have unlimited jobs/projects. For each job: - Name (e.g. "Rail Corridor Maintenance – Eastern Line") - Site, address, start/end date, status - **Required Roles** — toggle which roles are needed (Excavator Operator, Dogman, etc.) - Notes

This gives you a clean record of every active project per client.

3.3 Managing Job Roles

Clients & Rates → Job Roles tab

This is the global pool of role types — Excavator Operator, Dogman, Skilled Labourer, Foreman, etc. Add or remove any role here and it instantly becomes available when creating jobs.

3.4 Adding a Worker

Workers → + Add Worker

Required: - Full name, email - Worker Type (Casual / Full-Time / Subcontractor) - Pay Rate Regular (\$/hr)

Optional but recommended: - Mobile, address, job title, licences/tickets list, OT pay rate - Subcontractor ABN (only shown when type = Subcontractor)

After saving, the worker is in the database. To give them app access, they need an “Invite Sent” status — handled in **Pending Workers**.

3.5 Adding Tickets / Licences for a Worker

Licence Agent → + Add Licence

For each ticket: - Worker, licence name, issuer, expiry date

Tickets show up: - In the **Licence Agent** page (full list with expiry alerts) - In the worker’s **Edit modal** (bottom section) - In the **Dashboard** (Licence Alerts card if any expire within 30 days)

You can also filter the workers list by licence keyword (e.g. “EWP”) using the  **All Licences** dropdown on the Workers page.

4. Allocations (Scheduling)

Allocations → + Create Allocation

An allocation is “Worker X is going to Client Y’s site Z from date A to date B”.

Fields: - **Worker** — dropdown - **Client / Project / Site / Address** - **Site Supervisor + phone** — who the worker reports to onsite - **Start Date / End Date** — multi-day allocations supported - **Arrival Time / End Time** — time-only (date is taken from Start Date) - **Status** — Pending → Confirmed → Completed (or Cancelled) - **Notes**

The **Role column** in the allocations table shows the worker’s job title automatically.

Calendar View

Calendar — week-grid view of all allocations. Click an empty cell to create, click a bar to edit.

5. Timesheets

Worker submission

In the worker portal, the worker: 1. Goes to **My Timesheets** → **+ Submit Timesheet** 2. Picks **Shift Type**: Standard Shift or Rain Day (only 2 options for workers) 3. Enters date, hours, optional client/site/notes 4. Submits — status = pending

Admin approval / entry

In **Timesheets** (admin): 1. Filter to pending 2. Open a timesheet → review details 3. Set **Scenario** if needed (admin sees the full list — Late Start, Rain-Off Partial, Public Holiday, Annual Leave, etc.) 4. Approve or reject

Pay vs Charge logic

Different scenarios result in different pay/charge values. Examples:

Scenario	Pay Hours	Charge Hours
Standard	actual	actual
Rain-Off Partial	8.00	4.00
Rain-Off Cancelled	8.00	0.00
Late Start (Admin Fault)	8.00	actual
Annual Leave	8.00	0.00
Public Holiday (Full-Time only)	8.00	0.00
LWOP	0.00	0.00

This means **what the worker is paid is independent of what the client is charged** — important for rain days and admin-caused delays.

Penalty rates (auto-applied)

Based on the date and the Night Shift checkbox:

Day	Rate
Weekday standard	Normal pay rate (+ OT 1.5x past 7.6h)
Weekday night shift	First 8h × 1.5x, rest × 2x
Saturday	First 2h × 1.5x, rest × 2x

Day	Rate
Sunday / Public Holiday	All hours × 2x
Saturday/Sunday/PH night	All hours × 2x

All thresholds and multipliers are configurable in **Payroll Config**.

Allowances (auto-computed)

- **Travel allowance** (\$15) — paid to casual workers per shift
- **Meal allowance** (\$18.70) — auto-applied when shift hours ≥ 9.5h
- **Geographic loading** (+10%) — manual checkbox

6. Payroll

Payroll — runs the wage calculation across approved timesheets.

Workflow: 1. Pick a pay period (date range) 2. Filter rows you want to include 3. Click **Select All Unexported** — picks every approved timesheet not yet sent to Xero 4. Review the summary bar (total hours, total pay, period) 5. Either: - **Push to Xero** — creates a draft pay run in Xero with all selected timesheets - **Export Xero CSV** — downloads a CSV you can import manually

After a successful push, each timesheet is stamped `xero_exported = true` so it won't be sent twice.

Xero Connection

Payroll page → **Connect Xero** button. One-time OAuth — after that the portal stores refresh tokens and reconnects automatically.

Required Xero scopes: - `payroll.employees` - `payroll.payruns` - `payroll.payslip` - `accounting.contacts.read`

Xero Data Sync

Xero Data in the sidebar — read-only view of everything in your Xero account: - Employees (with pay rates from their Pay Template) - Pay run history with payslip drill-down - Contacts (clients/suppliers) - Leave applications - Pay setup (calendars, earnings rates, leave types, deductions)

The  **Sync Pay Rates → Workers** button on the Employees tab pulls each Xero employee's hourly rate and updates the matching portal worker (matched by full name).

7. Dashboard

The dashboard shows live operational stats:

Card	Click action
On Site Today	→ Workers
Available Pool	→ Workers
Awaiting Approval	→ Timesheets
Licence Alerts	→ Licence Agent
Week Billing	→ Payroll
Ready for Payroll	→ Payroll

Plus pinned panels: - **Urgent Alerts** — expired licences (dismissable) - **Pending Timesheets** — last 5 - **Today's Allocations** — full table with CSV export

8. Common Tasks (Cheat Sheet)

“Send a worker to a job tomorrow” 1. Workers → confirm worker exists & is Available 2. Allocations → Create Allocation → fill in worker, client, site, supervisor, dates, arrival time 3. Status: Confirmed 4. Bulk Messages (optional) → notify worker

“Approve a worker’s timesheet for a rain day” 1. Timesheets → filter to Pending 2. Open the row → set Scenario = “Rain-Off Cancelled” (or “Rain-Off Partial” if 4h work was done) 3. The pay/charge auto-fills (8h pay / 0h or 4h charge) 4. Status: Approved → Save

“Run payroll for last week” 1. Payroll → set date range to the period 2. Select All Unexported 3. Push to Xero (or Export CSV)

“Add a new licence type for a worker” 1. Licence Agent → + Add Licence 2. Pick worker, type the licence name, set expiry 3. Save — appears in their profile and on the dashboard alerts

“See who has an EWP ticket” 1. Workers →  Licence dropdown → “ewp” 2. List filters to only those workers

“Preview what a worker sees in their app” 1. Top bar →  Worker View 2. You’re now in the worker portal as yourself 3. ✕ Exit Preview to come back

9. Database Tables (for reference)

Table	Purpose
workers	Worker profiles + pay rates + worker_type +

Table	Purpose
	licences string
clients	Client records + charge rates
client_jobs	Jobs/projects under each client
job_roles	Global pool of role types
allocations	Worker assignments to jobs
timesheets	All shifts worked, with scenario / pay / charge / approval status
certifications	Tickets / licences with expiry dates
payroll_config	Configurable rate multipliers, thresholds, allowances
xero_tokens	OAuth tokens for Xero connection

10. Support / Common Issues

“Xero connection lost” → Payroll page → Reconnect Xero (re-runs OAuth)

“Worker can’t log in” → Pending Workers page → check their app_status; resend invite if needed

“Pay rate is wrong on a payroll row” → Check the worker’s pay_rate_regular in Workers, AND the date — rates differ for weekdays/Saturdays/Sundays/PH and night shifts

“Timesheet approved but not in payroll” → Check xero_exported status — if false, it’s still pickable; if true it’s already been sent

“Need to change overtime threshold” → Payroll Config page, edit ot_threshold_daily